

some text on the image, you can do it on a layer above the main image, so just in case you're not happy with the placement of the text, you have the freedom to move it around, modify it in any way you like and even delete it without affecting the layer beneath. Think of layers as plastic transparencies.

It's always recommended to do all image modifications on a new layer. If you need to touch up the main image itself, then duplicate it first.

Brushes: Brushes are a very important part of using Photoshop, be it for image manipulation, red-eye removal or even stamping. That's why it's advisable to get used to the brushes in Photoshop as soon as you can.

Filters: In photography, filters are placed over the lens to add a new element to the picture. With filters you can make a picture look brighter, give a colour overlay, add a mosaic effect, etc. Effectively, Photoshop filters do the same thing,



The 'Filters' menu

only you have a lot more variety of effects that you can add to a picture. There are already dozens of inbuilt effects that can make a photograph look like a water colour painting or a charcoal drawing; you can even add noise and scratches to give it an 'old' feel. Filters are fast, easy to use and very effective; that's why you'll find a variety of free and shareware filter plug-ins all over the Internet.



TIMESAVER TIP

Anti-aliasing: Open a new file, say about 30 by 200 pixels. Choose black as your foreground color. Click on the Type tool, then click on your file. This will bring up the Type dialog box. Make sure that the 'anti-aliasing' checkbox is checked. Set the type size to about 14 points, and type out, 'This is anti-aliased type.' Now, for comparison, open another new file. Click on the type tool, then click on your file. Type out 'This is not anti-aliased type.' Compare the two files. See the difference a little anti-aliasing can make!